MERCHANT OF BEAUTY

Owner's Guide

Your website, your dashboard and how to update your content

https://themerchantofbeauty.com

Written in plain language. No technical knowledge needed.

Keep this guide somewhere safe and share it with your trusted staff.

What is in this guide

Part	What it covers
1. Your website at a glance	What your customers see and how an order works
2. Logging in to the dashboard	The address, your login, and Owner vs Staff accounts
3. A tour of the dashboard	What every menu item does
4. Handling orders	Order statuses, invoices, and tracking
5. Creating your own invoices	For customers who order by WhatsApp, phone or in person
6. Customer reviews and ratings	How reviews arrive and how you approve them
7. Changing the look of your website	The Website Theme button (Owner only)
8. Managing your staff	Adding and removing dashboard users
9. Updating your website content	Products, categories, banners, contact details (Sanity)
10. Getting found on Google	What has been set up and what you can do
11. Questions and problems	Quick answers, and when to call your developer

How the website is built, in one paragraph
Your website has **two separate places** you will use. The **Dashboard** is where you handle orders, invoices, reviews and staff. **Sanity (the Studio)** is where you change what customers see: products, prices, photos, banners and contact details. They have different logins, and this guide explains both.

1. Your website at a glance

Customers visit **https://themerchantofbeauty.com** on their phone or computer. Here is what they can do:

- **Browse and search** your spa, salon and tattoo equipment by category.
- **Open a product** to see photos, price, description, whether it is in stock, and star ratings from other customers.
- **Add items to a cart** and place an order by giving their name, email, phone number and delivery address.
- **Track their order** using the Order ID they receive after ordering (the Track Order page).
- **Leave a review** with a 1 to 5 star rating on any product.
- **Contact you** through the WhatsApp button, phone and email, and find both your addresses in the footer and on the About page.

How an order travels

Step	What happens	Who does it
1	Customer places an order on the website	Customer
2	The order appears in your Dashboard as **Pending**	Automatic
3	You contact the customer, confirm the order and arrange payment and delivery	You / your staff
4	You move the order through the statuses (Confirmed, Processing, Shipped, Delivered)	You / your staff
5	You generate an invoice PDF for the order	You / your staff

Good to know
The website does **not** take card payments. An order is a request that you follow up with the customer directly. Please check the Dashboard regularly for new orders.

2. Logging in to the dashboard

The dashboard is private. Only people you give an account to can enter it.

1. Open **https://themerchantofbeauty.com/login** in any web browser (Chrome, Safari, Edge).
2. Type your **email** and **password**.
3. Press **Sign In**. You will land on the **Overview** page.

Staying signed in and signing out

- You stay signed in for about **8 hours** (one working day). After that you simply sign in again.
- When you finish, press **Sign Out** at the bottom of the left menu. Always do this on a shared or public computer.

Changing your password

1. In the left menu, at the bottom, press **Account Settings**.
2. Type your current password, then your new password (at least 6 characters).
3. Save. Use a long password that only you know and do not share it.

Two kinds of accounts

	Owner	Staff
Overview, Orders, Invoices, Reviews	Yes	Yes
Change own password	Yes	Yes
Add or remove staff	Yes	No
Change the Website Theme	Yes	No

Forgot your password?
There is no self-service reset yet. Ask your developer to set a new password for you, or, if you are a staff member, ask the Owner.

3. A tour of the dashboard

On the left you will see a dark menu. Here is what each item does:

Menu item	What it is for
Overview	A quick summary: total orders, total revenue (the value of all orders that are not cancelled, including ones still Pending), how many are Pending and how many are Delivered, plus your 5 most recent orders.
Orders	Every order placed on the website. Filter by status, open an order, update its status and create its invoice.
Invoices	Invoices you create yourself for customers who did not order through the website.
Reviews	Ratings and comments customers leave on products. You approve or reject them here.
Staff	Owner only. Add or remove people who can use the dashboard.
Home	Takes you back to the public website.
Account Settings	Bottom of the menu. Change your own password.
Website Theme button	Owner only. A black button at the bottom right of the dashboard that changes the colours of the whole website.

4. Handling orders

Finding and opening an order

1. Press **Orders** in the menu. Newest orders are at the top.
2. Use the buttons at the top (All, Pending, Confirmed, Processing, Shipped, Delivered, Cancelled) to show only orders in one stage.
3. Press any order to open it. You will see the customer's name, email, phone, address, notes, and the items ordered with prices.

What each status means

Status	Meaning	Use it when
Pending	New order, nobody has looked at it yet	Automatic when the customer orders
Confirmed	You have spoken to the customer and the order is agreed	After you confirm details and payment
Processing	You are preparing the items	While packing or sourcing
Shipped	The items are on their way	When handed to a courier or driver
Delivered	The customer has received the items	When delivery is complete
Cancelled	The order will not go ahead	If the customer or you cancel

Updating an order's status

1. Open the order.
2. On the right, under **Update Status**, choose the new status from the list.
3. Press **Update Status**. A green message confirms it saved. The customer can see the new status on the Track Order page.

Creating the invoice for an order

1. Open the order and look for the **Invoice** box.
2. Press **Generate Invoice**. An invoice number such as INV-0001 is created.
3. Press **View Invoice PDF** to open it. You can then save it, print it, or send it to the customer.

> **Important: Pending orders you never touch are deleted**
> To keep the system tidy, an order that is still **Pending** and has **not been touched for 2 days (48 hours)** is removed automatically. If an order is real, change its status (for example to Confirmed) as soon as you have spoken to the customer.

How customers track an order

After ordering, customers get an Order ID that looks like **ORD-XXXX-XXXX**. They enter it at **https://themerchantofbeauty.com/track** to see the current status. If a customer asks, you can read the Order ID to them from the top of the order page.

5. Creating your own invoices

Use this when a customer orders by WhatsApp, phone or in person, and you still want a professional invoice with your logo.

1. Press **Invoices** in the menu, then **+ New Invoice**.
2. Use the **Search products** box to find a product and add it. You can change the quantity.
3. Fill in the customer: **Customer Name** (required), Email, Phone, Address, and any Notes.
4. Press **Create Invoice**. You are taken to the invoice page.

What you can do with a saved invoice

Button	What it does
Download PDF	Downloads the invoice as a PDF with your logo, items and total.
Send via WhatsApp	Opens WhatsApp with a ready-written message and a link to the invoice, addressed to the customer's number. This button appears when you enter the customer's phone number and it is shown right after you press Create Invoice. If you reopen the invoice later from the list, the button may not show. In that case use Download PDF and send the file through WhatsApp yourself.
Mark as Sent	Changes the invoice label from *Draft* to *Sent* so you can see which ones you have already delivered.

> **Tip**
> Enter phone numbers the normal Nigerian way (for example 0801 234 5678). The system converts it to the international format WhatsApp needs.

6. Customer reviews and ratings

Customers can rate and review products. **Nothing appears on your website until you approve it**, so you stay in control.

What the customer sees

- At the bottom of every product page there is a **Reviews** section and a **Write a Review** form.
- They choose 1 to 5 stars, type their name and email, and can add a written comment (optional, up to 2000 characters).
- After sending, they are told the review will appear once approved.
- Their **email is never shown publicly**. It is only for your records.

What you do

1. Press **Reviews** in the dashboard menu. It opens on **Pending**, the reviews waiting for you.
2. Read each review. It shows the product, customer name and email, stars, date and comment.
3. Press **Approve** to publish it, or **Reject** to hide it.
4. Use the buttons at the top (Pending, Approved, Rejected, All) to look at older ones.

What happens after you approve

- The review appears on that product's page, newest first.
- The product shows its **average star rating** and number of reviews next to the title.
- Products with no approved reviews show no stars yet.

> **Please note**
> Once you press Approve or Reject the decision is final from the dashboard: the buttons disappear. Read carefully before deciding. To stop spam, one internet connection can send at most 5 reviews per hour.

A simple approval policy that works

- **Approve** honest reviews, including 3 star reviews. A mix of ratings makes the good ones more believable.
- **Reject** spam, adverts, rude language, and anything that is clearly not about the product.
- Check the Reviews page a few times a week so customers see their feedback quickly.

7. Changing the look of your website

Only the **Owner** account can do this. The change applies to the **whole website for every visitor**, and it stays until you change it again.

1. Sign in to the dashboard as the Owner.
2. At the bottom right, press the black **Website Theme** button.
3. Pick a theme from the list. The colours change straight away and a green message confirms it is saved for everyone.

Theme	Look and feel
Classic White	The original clean white and gold look
Warm Cream	Soft cream background, gentle and elegant
Dark Sections	White pages with black feature sections
Gold Tint	White with warm gold tinted sections
Full Dark	Whole site dark with gold accents

Theme	Look and feel
Combined (Dark + Gold Tint)	A mix of dark banner and gold tinted sections
Warm Charcoal / Charcoal Gold	Dark grey with strong gold
Midnight Gold	Nearly pure black, gold trim
Deep Navy	Dark blue with gold, very premium
MOB Signature (Black & Gold)	Black and gold, matching your logo exactly

> **Tip**
> Try a few themes and look at your homepage, a product page and the footer in each before you choose. If you ever want to go back, choose **Classic White**.

8. Managing your staff

Only the **Owner** sees the Staff page.

Adding a staff member

1. Press **Staff** in the menu.
2. Under **Add Staff Member**, type their name, email and a starting password (at least 6 characters).
3. Press **Add Staff Member**, then give them the email and password privately (for example in person).
4. Ask them to change the password themselves under **Account Settings**.

Removing a staff member

1. Under **All Accounts**, find the person.
2. Press **Remove** next to their name. They can no longer sign in.

> **Good habits**
> Give each person their own account. Never share the Owner login. Remove accounts of people who leave the business the same day.

9. Updating your website content (Sanity)

Sanity is the tool where you change what customers see. Think of it as the control room for your shop window. You do not need any technical skill: it works like filling in forms.

Opening Sanity

1. Open **https://themerchantofbeauty.com/admin-studio** in your browser.
2. Sign in with the account your developer invited (usually a Google email or similar). If you cannot sign in, ask your developer to invite your email address to the Sanity project.
3. You will see a menu with four items: **Product**, **Category**, **Hero Banner** and **Site Settings**.

> **The golden rule of Sanity: press Publish**
> Editing is saved as a **draft**. Customers only see your changes after you press the green **Publish** button at the bottom right of the editor. Changes usually appear on the website within a minute. If not, refresh the page a couple of times.

Adding a new product

1. Open **Product** and press the **+** (Create) button.
2. **Title**: the product name customers will see. (Required)
3. **Slug**: press **Generate**. This creates the web address of the product from the title. (Required)
4. **Price**: type the number only, in Naira, for example 150000. No commas and no currency sign. (Required)
5. **Category**: choose the group it belongs to (Spa, Salon, Tattoo and so on). (Required)
6. **Description**: a few clear sentences about the product. Good descriptions also help you get found on Google.
7. **Images**: upload clear photos. The first image is the main one shown first. Use bright, sharp pictures.
8. **In Stock**: switch on if you have it, off if it is sold out. Customers see 'Out of Stock' and cannot add it to the cart.
9. **Featured**: switch on to show it in the featured section of your homepage (up to 6 products show there).
10. Press **Publish**.

Changing a price, photo or stock

1. Open **Product** and press the product you want.
2. Change the field (for example the Price, or switch In Stock off).
3. Press **Publish**.

Removing a product

Open the product, press the three dots (...) at the bottom right, and choose **Unpublish** to hide it but keep it for later, or **Delete** to remove it for good. Old orders still keep the product name and price they were made with, so deleting a product never damages past orders.

Categories

- Open **Category** to add or rename groups such as Spa Equipment or Salon Equipment.
- **Title** and **Slug** are required (press Generate for the slug).
- **Icon** is a small square picture shown in the 'Shop by Category' strip on the homepage.
- Avoid deleting a category that still has products. Move those products to another category first.

Homepage Hero Banner

The big picture area at the top of your homepage has **five tiles**: Left Column Top, Left Column Bottom, Center (tall), Right Column Top and Right Column Bottom. Open **Hero Banner** and for each tile you can set:

Field	What it does
Image	The picture shown in that tile
Label	A short heading over the picture, for example 'New Arrivals'
CTA Text	The words on the button, for example 'Shop Now'
CTA Link	Where the button goes, for example /products or /products?category=spa-equipment

> **Photo tips**
> Use landscape photos for wide tiles and portrait photos for the tall centre tile. Keep the important part of the picture in the middle, as edges can be cropped on phones. Keep each photo under about 2 MB.

Site Settings: your business details

Open **Site Settings**. This is where you change the details shown in the footer, About page and contact areas:

Field	What to enter
Store Name	Merchant of Beauty
CEO / Founder	Name, title, short biography and photo for the 'Meet the Founder' section of the About page
Contact Email / Phone	Shown in the footer and About page
Main Address	A5 Plateau Plaza, Trade Fair Complex, Lagos
Showroom Address	Nze Odera Plaza, Sea Breeze, beside Polystar Building, Trade Fair Complex, Lagos
WhatsApp Number	With country code, digits only, no + and no spaces. Example: 2348012345678

Field	What to enter
Instagram / Twitter / Facebook	The full web address of each page, starting with https://
Website Theme	Best changed from the dashboard button (Part 7), but it is also shown here

Check twice
Wrong phone or WhatsApp numbers send customers to the wrong person. After you publish, open your website footer and About page and test the WhatsApp link once.

10. Getting found on Google

When someone searches for spa, salon or tattoo equipment in Nigeria, you want to appear. Here is what has been done for you:

- Every page has a proper **title** and **description** for search engines. Each product page uses the product name and description.
- A **sitemap** lists all your pages and products so Google can find them. It updates itself when you add products.
- A **robots file** tells search engines to skip private areas such as the dashboard and checkout.
- When someone shares your website on WhatsApp, Facebook or X, your logo appears in the preview.
- Your logo is also the small icon in the browser tab.

One-time setup (ask your developer to help)

1. Create a free **Google Search Console** account at search.google.com/search-console.
2. Add your website **https://themerchantofbeauty.com** and verify you own it.
3. Submit your sitemap: **https://themerchantofbeauty.com/sitemap.xml**.
4. Also create a free **Google Business Profile** for your showroom so you appear on Google Maps.

What you can do every week

- Give every product a **clear title** (for example 'Professional Hydraulic Salon Chair') and a **real description** of at least two or three sentences.
- Use **good, bright photos**. Keep prices and stock up to date.
- Approve genuine **reviews**. Stars make customers trust you and click more.
- Add new products regularly. Fresh content tells Google your shop is active.

Be patient
Google needs a few days to a few weeks to notice a new website and longer to rank it. That is normal.

11. Questions and problems

Problem	What to do
I changed something in Sanity but the website still shows the old version	Did you press **Publish**? If yes, wait a minute and refresh. If it is still old after 10 minutes, tell your developer.
A customer says they ordered but I cannot see the order	Check Orders with the filter on **All**. Ask for the Order ID. Remember Pending orders nobody touched for 2 days are removed.
I cannot log in to the dashboard	Check your email spelling and password. Still stuck: ask the Owner or your developer to reset it.
I cannot log in to Sanity	Your email may not be invited yet. Ask your developer to invite it.
I do not see the Website Theme button or the Staff menu	These are for the Owner account only.
A customer wants to change their order	Contact them, then update the order status or notes. Create a fresh invoice if needed.
A review is rude or fake	Press **Reject**. It will not appear on the website.
The invoice PDF looks wrong	Check the customer details and items, create it again, and tell your developer if it repeats.

Golden rules

- Press **Publish** in Sanity after every change.
- Update order statuses as they move, so customers can track them.
- Approve or reject reviews a few times a week.
- Never share the Owner password. Remove staff who leave.
- Sign out on shared computers.

> **Need help?**
> Write down what you were doing, what you expected, and what happened (a screenshot helps a lot), then send it to your developer.